Yue Chen

Curriculum Vitae

Research Interests

Language Acquisition, Language Processing, Multilingualism, Cognition

Education

University of Southern California (USC)

2024 - Present **Ph.D. Linguistics**

The University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

2023 **B.A. Linguistics and Psychology,** Minor in Comparative Literature

Honors Thesis 1: Acquisition of English Reflexive Pronouns: Evidence from Naturalistic Observation
Advisor: Catherine M. Sandhofer

Honors Thesis 2: Unveiling the Parallel Function Hypothesis on Personal Pronouns: A Corpus Analysis Utilizing Eye-Tracking Data
Advisor: Jesse Harris

Summer School

2023 /L+/ International Summer / Winter School on Language Acquisition, University of Potsdam, Online
2025 The North American Summer School for Logic, Language and Information (NASSLLI '25), University of Washington, Seattle, Online

Scholarship and Awards

2022 UCLA/Keck Humanistic Inquiry Undergraduate Research Award (Keck)
2023 Rose Gilbert in Memory of Maggie Gilbert Scholarship
2023 UCLA College of Letters and Science College Honors
2023 UCLA Linguistics Department Honors
2023 UCLA College of Letters and Science Latin Honors: Cum Laude
2025 Paula Menyuk Award for BUCLD50
2026 Travel Award for HSP 2026

Journal Publications

1. Fuchs, Z., Kealey, E., Eldem, E., Mermelstein, L., Pham, L., Runova, A., **Chen, Y**., Oguz, M., Hong, S., Pan, C., Subramony, J., (2025). Measuring Adult Heritage Language Lexical Proficiency for Studies on Facilitative Processing of Gender. In O. Ivanova & Ó. Loureda (Eds.), Language Processing in Spanish Heritage Speakers [Special issue]. Languages, 10(8), 189. https://doi.org/10.3390/languages10080189

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2. Mai, Z., Wong, P. C., Matthews, S., Yip, V., Liao, H., Nie, J., **Chen, Y**. (2025). Zhuang-Mandarin bilingual children in rural China and the role of grandparental input in early bilingualism. PloS one, 20(6), e0326671.

Conference Proceedings

1. **Chen, Y**. (in press). From *um* to Words: The Role of Disfluency Interactions in Shaping Early Language Development. In Proceedings of 50th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD)
2. **Chen, Y**., Shang, M., & Mai, Z. (2025). Cross-Linguistic Influence and Developmental Patterns in Reflexive Pronoun Use Among Monolingual, Bilingual, and Trilingual Children. In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (Vol. 47). https://escholarship.org/uc/item/7xs6k5h2

Selected Conference Presentations and Posters

1. Charan, D., **Chen, Y**., Grachek, D., Huang, P.-H., He, M., Hsu, H., Li, J., Wang, Y., & Breiss, C. (2026, April). *A large-scale corpus investigation of Italian troncamento*. **[Poster]** Southern California April Meeting on Phonology (SCAMP), University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA.
2. **Chen, Y**. (2026, March). *Too Much Information? Mandarin Classifiers from Humans to LLMs*. **[Poster]** 39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 39), Cambridge, MA.
3. **Chen, Y.** (2025, November). *From 'Um' to Words: The Role of Disfluency Interactions in Shaping Early Language Development*. **[Poster] (One of the top-rated student submissions; Paula Menyuk Award)** 50th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD), Boston, MA.
4. **Chen, Y**., Mai, Z., Shang, M., (2025, July). *Cross-Linguistic Influence and Developmental Patterns in Reflexive Pronoun Use Among Monolingual, Bilingual, and Trilingual Children*. [**Poster**] CogSci 2025, San Francisco, CA.
5. Fuchs, Z., Kealey, E., Eldem, E., Mermelstein, L., Pham, L., Runova, A., Hong, S., Oguz, M., **Chen, Y.**, Pan, C., Subramony, J., (2025, June). *Predicting facilitative processing of gender in Heritage Spanish using measures of lexical proficiency*. 16th Heritage Language Research Institute (HLRI), [**Poster**] Madison, WI.
6. **Chen, Y.**, Mai, Z., Chen, Y., (2024, November). *Employing Machine Learning and Language Models to Differentiate Language Patterns in Mandarin-Speaking Preschoolers with Autism Spectrum Disorder*. [**Poster**] California Meeting on Psycholinguistics 7 (CAMP7), San Diego, CA.
7. **Chen, Y.**, Su, Y., (2024, November). *Exploring Reflexive Pronoun Development and Usage in Mandarin-Learning Toddlers: A Comparative Study of ASD and TD Groups*. [**Poster**] California Meeting on Psycholinguistics 7 (CAMP7), San Diego, CA.
8. **Chen, Y**., Mai, Z., Hu, X., Shang, M., (2024, July). *Reflexive pronouns in Chinese-learning monolingual, bilingual, and trilingual toddlers, and their parental input*. [**Poster**] Child Language Symposium 2024, Newcastle, UK.

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9. **Chen, Y.** (2024, May). *Unveiling the Parallel Function Hypothesis on Personal Pronouns: A Corpus Analysis Utilizing Eye-Tracking Data*. [**Poster**] The 11th Conference on Language, Discourse, and Cognition, Taipei, Taiwan.
10. **Chen, Y.** (2023, February). *Acquisition of English Reflexive Pronouns: Evidence from Naturalistic Observation*. [**Poster**], 22nd Meeting of the Texas Linguistics Society, Austin, TX.

Undergraduate Publications

1. **Chen, Y.**, Neer, E., Zhang, E., Sandhofer, C.M., (2024). Acquisition of English Reflexive Pronouns: Evidence from Naturalistic Observation. UCLA Undergraduate Psychology Journal, 11(1), 6-16.

Teaching Experience

TAships at University of Southern California

Fall 2025: **LING115 Language and Society**
Instructor: Professor Andrew Simpson
Spring 2026: **LING 385**: Human Language as Computation
Instructor: Khalil Iskarous

Working Manuscript

- From "Um" to Words: The Role of Disfluency Interactions in Shaping Early Language Development
- Who Is Whom? Influences of Theta Roles and Discourse Topicality on the Resolution of Mandarin Reflexives
- Who Feels, Who Causes? Empathy Locus and Discourse Coherence in Large Language Models

Work Experiences

2023 - 2024 **Linguistics Research Assistant for Professor Maggie Mai from CUHK**
Involved in multiple research projects, including modeling, CHILDES corpus building, early multilingual development and heritage language acquisition and processing, responsible for literature review, manuscript preparation, coordination between different laboratories and academics, transcription using CLAN and CHAT, and data collection.

Lab Experiences

2024 - **Psycholinguistics of Mono- and Multilingualism Lab (PoMMLab)**
Involved in stimulus creation, in charge of data organization.
Principal Investigator: Zuzanna Fuchs

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2021- 2023 **Language Processing Lab**
Involved in phonetics stimulus creation by using Praat, in charge of data organization, running eye-tracking, pupillometry, self-paced reading, and reading reaction experiments both in person and online.
Principal Investigator: Jesse Harris

2021- 2023 **Language and Cognition Development Lab**
Involved in Research design, in charge of critical thinking and methodology development for social cue projects, data (behavior) coding, lexicon building for each transcript, utterance by utterance transcription of each video by using CLAN, data organization, data analysis, creating RA manuals, new RA-training, and literature review of articles related to social cues and parent-child interactions.
Principal Investigator: Catherine M. Sandhofer
Ph.D. Student Supervisors: Emily Neer and Erjing Zhang

Summer 2022 **Language Acquisition Lab**
In charge of subject scheduling and recruitment, organizing timeslot, and helping run in-person infant preferential-looking paradigm experiments.
Principal Investigator: Megha Sundara and Laurel Perkins

Public and University Events

Winter 2023 **Invited Presenter,** Bruin Day for Admitted Transfers, UCLA
A presentation on my current honors thesis, sharing insights from my undergraduate research journey as a first-generation college student at UCLA. The session will include a Q&A on conducting research and accessing resources as an undergraduate.

Academic Service

2025 – 2026: **Colloquium Coordinator (with Yingyu Su)**, Graduate Students in Linguistics (GSiL), University of Southern California (USC)
2025: **Conference Support**, Workshop on Theoretical East Asian Linguistics 14 (TEAL-14), University of Southern California (USC)

Reviewer: CAMP7, CAMP8, SAIS 2025, CogSci 2025, CogSci 2026, AMCIS 2025, PACIS 2025

Volunteer

UCLA Undergraduate Research Peer Mentor
Child Rescue Organization - China (Non-Profit)
Exploring Your Universe (EYU) - UCLA Psychology Department

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Skills

Language: Mandarin Chinese (Native), Wu Chinese (Native), English, Spanish, Italian
Programming skills: C/C++, Python (NumPy, PyTorch, Transformers), MATLAB, R

Data presentation and analysis: SPSS, MATLAB, LaTeX, Praat, ELAN, CLAN, Qualtrics, SynthWorks, Rezonator, PCIbex

Other Services and Memberships

Present	Member of the Linguistics Society of America
Present	Cognitive Science Society
Present	Human Sentence Processing